JIAYI LU

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ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor *2025-present*
Department of Linguistics, Northwestern University
Affiliated: Cognitive Science Program

Postdoctoral Fellow *2024-2025*
Department of Linguistics, University of Pennsylvania
Advisors: Julie Anne Legate, Charles Yang

EDUCATION

PhD in Linguistics *2024*
Department of Linguistics, Stanford University
Dissertation Committee: Judith Degen (Chair), Michael C. Frank, Daniel Lassiter, Thomas Wasow

BA in Linguistics, Neuroscience, Integrated Science *2019*
summa cum laude
Northwestern University
Thesis advisors: Masaya Yoshida, Shayne Sloggett

Linguistics Summer Session *2017*
Universiteit Utrecht

The LSA Linguistics Institute *2017*
University of Kentucky

RESEARCH INTERESTS

(Formal and Experimental) Syntax, Psycholinguistics,

PUBLICATIONS

†: Student author *: Equal contributions

Yang, X.†, **Lu, J.** (accepted). Islands Satiate without Change in Backgroundedness. *Glossa*

Lu, J., and Kim, N. (2026). Adjunct Island Effect on Wh-Scrambling in Korean. *Glossa* 11(1)

Lu, J., Legate, J.A., and Yang, C. (2026). The Learnability of Bridge Effects. *Journal of Linguistics*, 1–43.

Lu, J.*, Pan, D.*, and Degen, J. (2025). Evidence for a Discourse Account of Manner-of-Speaking Islands. *Language* 101(4): 627–659

Lu, J., Frank, M., and Degen, J. (2024). Which Islands Satiate: a Meta-Analysis. *Glossa Psycholinguistics 3*(1): X, 1–33

Lu, J., Merchan, J., Wang, L., and Degen, J. (2024). Can Syntactic Log-Odds Ratio Predict Acceptability and Satiation?. *Society for Computation in Linguistics* 7(1): 10-19

Kim, N., and **Lu, J.**. (2024). Coordination of Unlike Categories Creates Grammaticality Illusion. *Korean Journal of English Language and Linguistics 24*(1): 52–61

Zhan, M., Chen, S., Levy, R., **Lu, J.**, and Gibson, E. (2023). Rational Sentence Interpretation in Mandarin Chinese. *Cognitive Science 47*(12): e13383.

Kim, N., Li, Z., and **Lu, J.** (2023). Island-Sensitivity of Two Different Interpretations of *Why* in Chinese. *Frontiers in Psychology 13*: 1059823.

Lu, J., Wright, N., and Degen, J. (2022). Satiation Effects Generalize Across Island Types. *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*: 2724–2730.

Lu, J., and Kim, N. (2022). The Puzzle of Argument Structure Mismatch in Gapping. *Frontiers in Psychology 13*: 907823.

Kim, N., and **Lu, J.** (2022). Predictive Sentence Processing: Evidence from Passive Relative Clause Processing. *Korean Journal of English Language and Linguistics 22*(1): 70–85.

Kim, N., and **Lu, J.** (2021). An Illusion of Grammaticality in Wh-Questions. *Korean Journal of Linguistics 46*(3): 607–618.

Lu, J., Lassiter, D., and Degen, J. (2021). Syntactic satiation is driven by speaker-specific adaptation. *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*: 1493–1499.

Lu, J., Thompson, C.K., and Yoshida, M. (2020). Chinese Wh-in-situ and Islands: a Formal Judgment Study. *Linguistic Inquiry 51*(3): 611–623

UNPUBLISHED MANUSCRIPTS

Lu, J. (2022). An Adjunction Analysis of Clause Chaining in Turkish. Second PhD Qualifying Paper.

Lu, J. (2021). Satiation as Rapid Syntactic Adaptation. First PhD Qualifying Paper.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

†: Student author *: Equal contributions

Dowling, R.†, **Lu, J.** (2027). Cataphoric Pronoun Suspends the Ban on [-Human] Non-obligatory Control. Talk to be presented at the 2027 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.

Wang, A.†, Davis, F., and **Lu, J.** (2027). Real-time Evidence for Good-enough Lexical Representation. Talk to be presented at the 2027 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.

Lu, J., Yang, X.†, and Kim, N. (2027). Real-time Satiation of the That-trace Effect: Evidence for the Adaptation Account of Satiation. Talk to be presented at the 2027 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.

Ronai, E.*, **Lu, J.***, Wang, A.†, and Feng, J.† (2026). Evidence for Adaptation in Scalar Implicature Calculation. To be presented at the 2026 Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM) conference, Philadelphia, PA.

Yang, X.†, **Lu, J.** (2026). Island Satiates without Change in Backgroundedness. To be presented at the 2026 Human Sentence Processing (HSP) conference, Cambridge, MA.

Lu, J. (2026). Availability of Acceptable Alternatives Modulates Satiation. The 2026 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, New Orleans, LA.

Lu, J., Legate, J.A., and Yang, C. (2025). Examining the bridge/non-bridge verb distinction in Mandarin Chinese. The 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), College Park, Maryland.

Lu, J., Papineau, B., Jeong, S., Hernandez, A., Goodwin, E., and Anttila, A. (2025). Interspeaker Variation in Copular Agreement with Disjoined Subjects: an Optimality-Theoretic Account. The 2025 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

Lu, J.*, Merchan, J.*, Wang, L.*, and Degen, J. (2024). Can Syntactic Log-Odds Ratio Predict Acceptability and Satiation?. The 2024 Meeting of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL), Irvine, California.

Merchan, J.*, Wang, L.*, **Lu, J.***, and Degen, J. (2024). Can Language Model Surprisal Predict Acceptability and Satiation. The 2024 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), Stanford, California.

Yao, R., **Lu, J.**, and Degen, J. (2024). Perceived interpretability predicts satiability for Complex NP island but not Whether-island. The 2024 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), Stanford, California.

Lu, J.*, Pan, D.*, and Degen, J. (2024). Evidence for a Discourse Account of Manner-of-Speaking Islands. The 2024 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, New York City, New York.

Pan, D.*, **Lu, J.***, and Degen, J. (2023). Discourse Foregrounding Ameliorates Manner-of-Speaking Islands. The 36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), Pittsburg, PA.

Lu, J., and Degen, J. (2023). Which Islands Satiate: a Meta-analysis. The 2023 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), Los Angeles, California.

Pan, D.*, **Lu, J.***, and Degen, J. (2023). Can Manner-of-Speaking Islands be Rescued Through Discourse Foregrounding?. The 2023 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP). Los Angeles, CA.

Lu, J., and Degen, J. (2023). Which Island-violating Sentences Satiate: a Meta-analysis. The 2023 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado.

Lu, J., and Kim, N. (2023). Coordination of Unlike Categories Creates Grammaticality Illusion. The 2023 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado.

Lu, J., Wright, N., and Degen, J. (2022). Satiation effects generalize across island types. The 44th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Toronto, Canada.

Wright, N., **Lu, J.** and Degen, J. (2022). What is the representational target of island satiation effects?. The 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), Santa Cruz, California (Online).

Lu, J. and Kim, N. (2022). Maximizing Parallelism in the Processing of Gapping: Evidence from Argument Structure Mismatches. The 2022 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) annual conference, Washington, D.C.

Lu, J. (2021). Reducing conjunct islands to adjunct islands: Evidence from Turkish. The 2021 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) annual conference, San Francisco, California (Online due to COVID-19).

Lu, J., Lassiter, D., and Degen, J. (2021). Satiation of Island Constraints is Partially Syntactic Adaptation. The 2021 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) annual conference, San Francisco, California (Online).

Lu, J., Walenski, M., and Thompson, C.K. (2019). EEG Evidence for Different Syntactic Expectations in Parsing Chinese Subject and Object-relative Clauses. The International Brain and Syntax Think Tank, Evanston, Illinois.

Lu, J., Thompson, C.K., and Yoshida, M. (2019). Examining Argument-Adjunct Asymmetry of Island Effect in Mandarin Chinese. The 2019 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, New York City, New York.

Lu, J., Thompson, C.K., and Yoshida, M. (2018). Chinese Wh-in-situ and Islands: a Formal Judgment Study. The 2018 Annual Conference on Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP), Berlin, Germany.

Lu, J., Walenski, M., and Thompson, C.K. (2018). EEG Evidence for Different Syntactic Expectations in Parsing Chinese Subject and Object-relative Clauses. The 2018 Society of Neurobiology of Language (SNL) annual conference, Quebec City, Canada.

Lu, J. and Ward, G. (2018). *Verb Meaning and Subject-Position Zero-Pronoun Comprehension in Mandarin Chinese.* The 2018 Southern California Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (SCULC), Los Angeles, California.

Lu, J. (2017). Processing Asymmetry in Mandarin Chinese Relative Clauses: A Literature Review and Suggestions for Future Studies. The 2017 Great Lakes Expo for Experimental and Formal Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (GLEEFUL), East Lansing, Michigan.

INVITED TALKS

Probing the Satiation of Island Effects *2025*
ILST Talk Series, University of Pennsylvania

Probing the Satiation of Island Effects *2025*
Psychology of Language Lab, Princeton University

From Input to Change:
How Input Shapes Linguistic Knowledge and Language Use *2025*
Pomona College

Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island *2024*
Speech and Sentence Processing Lab, University of California, Santa Cruz

An Adjunction Analysis of Clause Chaining in Turkish *2023*
Syntax and Semantics Circle (SSCircle), University of California, Berkeley

Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island *2023*
Language and Cognition Lab, Sungkyunkwan University, South Korea

Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island *2023*
School of Foreign Studies, Nanjing University, China

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Integrated Language Sciences and Technology (ILST) Travel Grant, University of Pennsylvania *2025*

Integrated Language Sciences and Technology (ILST) Small Grant, University of Pennsylvania *2025*

Graduate Research Opportunity Grant ($4,850), Stanford University *2023 - 2024*

Centennial Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford University *2023*

Departmental Research Grant ($1,000), Stanford University Department of Linguistics *2020*

Phi Beta Kappa, Northwestern University *2019*

Community Service Award, Northwestern University Integrated Science Program *2019*

Fletcher Undergraduate Research Award, Northwestern University *2017*

Abraham Demoz Prize in Linguistics, Northwestern University *2017*

Academic Year Undergraduate Research Grant ($1,000 each), Northwestern University *2017, 2019*

GLEEFUL Conference Travel Award, Michigan State University *2017*

Excellence in Mathematics by a First Year Student, Northwestern University *2016*

Dean's List: 2015 Fall to 2019 Spring (12 Quarters), Northwestern University *2015 - 2019*

SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

Canadian Journal of Linguistics, Folia Linguistica, Frontiers in Psychology, Glossa Psycholinguistics, Journal of Cognition, Journal of East Asian Linguistics, Journal of Linguistics, Journal of Memory and Language, Language, Languages, Lingua, Linguistic Inquiry, Linguistics: An Interdisciplinary Journal of the Language Sciences, Natural Language & Linguistic Theory, PLOS One, University of Georgia Working Papers in Linguistics, Zeitschrift für Sprachwissenschaft.

Conference Reviewer

Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) 2026, Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci) 2022 - 2025, California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP) 2021 - 2025, Linguistics Society of America Annual Meeting (LSA) 2025 - 2026, Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC) 2025 - 2026, West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 2022 - 2025.

Conference Organizing Committees

6th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 6) *2024*
40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 40) *2022*

Departmental Service

Colloquium Committee, Northwestern Linguistics *2026 - 2027*
Department 50th Anniversary Event organizer, Northwestern Integrated Science Program *2026*
QP Fest Committee, Stanford Linguistics *2023*
Undergraduate mentor TA, Stanford Linguistics *2022 - 2024*
Colloquium Committee, Stanford Linguistics *2021 - 2022*
Application reviewer and mentor, Stanford CSLI Summer Internship Program *2021 - 2022*
Coordinator for Stanford Syntax and Morphology Circle (SMircle) *2020 - 2022*
Social Committee, Stanford Linguistics *2019 - 2020*
Weinberg College Student Advisory Board, Northwestern University *2018 - 2019*
Integrated Science Program Student Programming Board, Northwestern University *2018 - 2019*
Coordinator for Syntax Club, Northwestern Linguistics *2017 - 2019*

TEACHING AND MENTORING

As primary instructor:

Northwestern University

LING 230: Language and Mind *2026 Fall*
LING 400: Seminar: Linguistics Adaptation *2026 Spring*
LING 460: Syntactic Analysis *2026 Winter*
LING 360: Fundamentals of Syntax *2025 Fall*
GEN-LA 298: Alternative Science: Pseudoscience, Parascience, and Fringe Science *2018 Spring*

University of Pennsylvania

LING 2500: Introduction to Syntax *2024 Fall*

Stanford University

LINGUIST 196: Introduction to Undergraduate Research *2023 Winter, Fall*
LINGUIST 195A: Undergraduate Research Workshop *2023 Winter, Spring, 2024 Winter, Spring*

As teaching assistant:

Stanford University

LINGUIST 130B: Introduction to Lexical Semantics (Instructor: Cleo Condoravdi) *2024 Spring*
LINGUIST 121A: The Syntax of English (Instructor: Bonnie Krejci) *2023 Spring*

LINGUIST 130: Introduction to Semantics and Pragmatics (Instructor: Chris Potts) *2022 Winter*
LINGUIST 145: Introduction to Psycholinguistics (Instructor: Judith Degen) *2020 Fall*

Graduate students:
Anzi Wang *2025-present*

Undergraduate research advisees:
Ruby Dowling *2026-present*
Xiaohan Yang *2025-2026*
Jonathan Merchan (Stanford University) *2023*
Lian Wang (Stanford University) *2023*
Ruoqing Yao (College of William and Mary, through the Stanford CSLI program) *2022*
Nicholas Wright (College of William and Mary, through the Stanford CSLI program) *2021*

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Advisor: Ted Gibson) *2018*
Summer Research Intern
Northwestern University (Advisor: Masaya Yoshida) *2017-2019*
Research Assistant
Northwestern University (Advisor: Cynthia K. Thompson) *2016-2019*
Research Assistant

SKILLS

Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Turkish (research knowledge), Japanese (research knowledge), Samoan (research knowledge) Korean (research knowledge)
Programming Languages	Python, javascript, HTML, WebPPL
Software and Tools	LaTeX, R, ELAN, Praat, OTSoft